



Reptiles, Hot or Cold?



You might have heard that reptiles are cold-blooded animals. What makes reptiles unique and why are they cold-blooded? How do reptiles keep warm if they do not have any fur or feathers?

Reptiles,
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Reptiles are sun-seekers. They love the sun. Their body temperature heats up in the sun. They are cold-blooded. And this explains why many reptiles hibernate in winter.

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Reptiles are vertebrates. This means that they are an animal with a backbone. There is a long list of reptile species. Reptiles include species of snakes, turtles, crocodiles, alligators and lizards. They can be found in many parts of the world.

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Reptiles have dry scales, instead of fur or feathers. Sometimes they shed their scales and replace them with a new set. Their skin has adapted to some extreme environments. They can live in hot, dry deserts. They can live on land. They can live in trees. They can even spend time in the sea.

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Many reptiles eat meat. They might eat smaller animals like insects, frogs, mice, fish and birds.

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In order to move, many reptiles walk on four limbs. Snakes move by pushing their scales over the ground and pulling forward. Turtles have flippers to help them swim. Alligators and crocodiles whip their tails from side to side in the water.

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There are many reptiles that lay soft-shelled eggs. Some lay just one egg and some can lay over one hundred. Finally, reptiles live a long life. They grow throughout their lives.

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